

ALKA MAHAPATRA

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Professional Highlights

- **5+ years across Product Design, UX Research, Visual Design and Product Strategy**, spanning startups, consulting, B2B SaaS, enterprise, consumer, eCommerce, and AI-enabled products.
- Take ambiguous problems from **research and problem framing through requirements, flows, prototypes, polished UI, Engineering collaboration, and iteration**.
- Experienced with **0→1 products, complex workflows, dashboards, internal tools, responsive web, native mobile, and design systems**.
- AI-forward builder using **Claude, Cursor, Figma Make, Git/GitHub, and GenAI workflows** for research, ideation, functional prototyping, frontend exploration, and handoff.
- **Proficient in Figma, Adobe Photoshop, and Adobe Illustrator**, with strong foundations in visual craft, interaction design, accessibility, and systems thinking.
- Comfortable working as a **self-starter in fast-paced, resource-constrained environments**, partnering directly with founders, Product, Engineering, clients, executives, and SMEs.
- Led and mentored **3 designers** and contributed to measurable outcomes including **+10.6% web conversion, +35% app engagement and 62% production-cost savings**.

Skills

- **Product & Strategy:** 0→1 Product Design • Product Discovery • Product Strategy • Problem Framing • Opportunity Identification • Requirements Definition • Feature Prioritization • End-to-End Product Design • Systems Thinking • Customer & Business Alignment
- **UX & Interaction:** Information Architecture • User Flows • Complex Workflows • Interaction Design • Responsive Web • Native Mobile • Dashboards • Internal Tools • High-Fidelity UI • Design Systems • Accessibility
- **UX Research:** Customer Interviews • Stakeholder Interviews • Surveys • Diary Studies • Contextual Inquiry • Usability Testing • Ethnographic Research • Heuristic Evaluation • Competitive Analysis • Journey Mapping • Affinity Mapping • Research Synthesis
- **AI & Prototyping:** Claude • Claude Code • Cursor • ChatGPT • Gemini • Figma AI • Figma Make • Base44 • Lovable • v0 • Replit • GitHub Copilot • Prompt & Context Engineering • Functional Prototyping • AI-Assisted Research
- **Design & Creative:** Figma • FigJam • Miro • ProtoPie • Rive • After Effects • Adobe Photoshop • Adobe Illustrator • InDesign • Sketch • Adobe XD • Typography • Layout • Visual Hierarchy • Motion
- **Technical & Delivery:** Git/GitHub • VS Code • HTML • CSS • JavaScript Familiarity • Figma Dev Mode • Developer Handoff • Design QA • Agile • Jira • Confluence • Storyblok • Shopify • WordPress
- **Analytics & Experimentation:** GA4 • Hotjar • Microsoft Clarity • A/B Testing • Funnel Analysis • Behavioral Analytics • Heatmaps • Session Recordings • Conversion Optimization

Relevant Work Experience

UX Consultant, Cocoon Technologies - USA (Remote)

Jan 2026 - Present

- Shape a 0→1 accessibility-first native-mobile and web product, working from stakeholder research and problem framing through product requirements, journeys, interaction logic, prototypes, and continued iteration.
- Designed multi-user workflows across real-time communication, permissions, documents, consent, sensitive information, notifications, escalation, emergency contacts, and history, accounting for operational and real-world edge cases.
- Balance usability, accessibility, privacy, safety, product logic, and technical feasibility while collaborating with domain stakeholders and technical partners.

Product Designer & UX Researcher, Haptiq - New York

June 2025 - June 2026

- Owned end-to-end design workstreams across B2B SaaS, enterprise, consumer, and operational products, turning ambiguous customer, business, and technical problems into research, requirements, IA, workflows, prototypes, high-fidelity UI, and scalable product patterns.
- Conducted and synthesized customer/stakeholder interviews, contextual inquiry, usability testing, heuristic evaluations, competitive analysis, and affinity mapping, translating findings into prioritized product opportunities and feature decisions.
- Designed complex dashboards, internal tools, pricing-management experiences, service workflows, product discovery/configuration, filtering systems, CMS/admin interfaces, and responsive web experiences.
- Partnered directly with Product, Engineering, executives, clients, SMEs, Sales/business stakeholders, and data partners to resolve tradeoffs across user needs, business priorities, technical feasibility, legacy constraints, and delivery.
- Built and maintained reusable Figma systems using components, variants, variables, component properties, Auto Layout, responsive patterns, and documentation, supporting implementation through Dev Mode and design QA.
- Used AI-assisted research and prototyping to generate alternatives, pressure-test product logic, identify edge cases, and make complex ideas tangible earlier in the product-development process.

UX Designer (Accessibility), Michigan Publishing - Michigan, USA

Feb 2025 - May 2025

- Conducted structured UX and accessibility evaluations using WCAG 2.2 AA, Section 508, EN 301 549, VoiceOver, NVDA, TalkBack, Axe, WAVE, keyboard testing, and manual review.
- Translated findings into prioritized remediation recommendations, roadmap inputs, VPAT-related documentation, training materials, and reusable UX guidance.
- Worked across user impact, compliance, technical feasibility, and implementation effort to help teams make practical product decisions.

UX Lead & Manager (1y 1m), promoted from UX/UI Designer (7m), Transformative Ventures - India

Oct 2022 – May 2024

- Led end-to-end Product/UX Design and mentored 3 designers across a 1.5M+ user consumer web and native-mobile ecosystem, spanning product discovery, personalization, recommendations, cart, checkout, onboarding, tracking, engagement, and retention.
- Used customer feedback, surveys, A/B testing, heatmaps, session recordings, funnel analysis, and behavioral analytics to identify opportunities and determine what to prioritize next.
- Contributed to +10.6% web conversion, -18% bounce rate, +35% engagement, +50% app conversion, ~\$100K app impact, and +7 minutes average session duration through iterative product, interaction, and visual improvements.
- Partnered with Product, Engineering, Analytics, Marketing, Media Buying, Content, Brand, and leadership to connect customer insight, business KPIs, experimentation, product priorities, and execution.
- Designed detailed interaction behavior across personalization, recommendations, loading/progress states, gestures, transitions, microinteractions, and success states while establishing reusable patterns across web and mobile.

UX Designer, Network for Conserving Central India - India

Jun 2023 – Aug 2023

- Conducted stakeholder interviews, content audits, usability evaluation, and information-architecture analysis to clarify an ambiguous redesign problem.
- Translated research into prioritized UX recommendations, revised IA, user flows, wireframes, and accessibility improvements.

Associate UX/UI Designer, Kandle (formerly dRisk) - IndiaJul 2022 – Aug 2022

- Worked directly with the founder and developers on a 0→1 fintech product, translating emerging business and user requirements into flows, dashboards, responsive prototypes, and foundational interaction patterns.
- Operated independently in an early-stage environment, moving quickly from ambiguity to testable product concepts while balancing user needs, business priorities, and technical constraints.

Associate Graphic Designer, Trendgully - IndiaMar 2022 – Apr 2022

- Translated fashion forecasts, streetwear trends, visual culture and client briefs into consumer-facing graphics and merchandise concepts, balancing aesthetic direction with audience and commercial requirements.
- Developed visual concepts using Adobe Creative Suite across fashion and eCommerce contexts, strengthening expertise in composition, typography, color and culturally relevant visual storytelling.

Senior Executive - Graphic Designer (10m), converted from Design Intern (4m), Blackberrys Menswear - IndiaJan 2021 – Feb 2022

- Designed and maintained visual systems across a national fashion brand's product communication, packaging, retail collateral, catalogs, garment tags and brand touchpoints, applying strong typography, composition, hierarchy, iconography and production craft.
- Partnered with Design, sourcing, category and production teams to translate brand and merchandising requirements into scalable artwork and production-ready specifications.
- Redesigned a fragmented system of 3–8 garment tags into one cohesive information system, reducing annual printing/production cost by 62% while maintaining brand and product-information requirements.

Research Analyst, Arvora - IndiaNov 2020 – Dec 2020

- Conducted ethnographic fieldwork, contextual inquiry, artisan interviews, and secondary research for Odisha's Silver Filigree GI documentation initiative.
- Synthesized cultural, historical, material, and production insights across artisans, SMEs, and government-linked stakeholders.

Education

- Master of Science in Information (UX Research & Design), University of Michigan - Ann Arbor2024-2026
Focus: Interaction Design • User-Centered Design • Responsive Web • UX Research • Information Architecture • Accessibility | GPA: 4.0 / 4.0
- Bachelor of Design, National Institute of Fashion Technology - New Delhi2017-2021
Focus: Fashion & Consumer Research • Visual Communication • Typography • Layout • Color • Graphic Design • Trend Research • Brand Storytelling • Photography • Product Development | GPA: 8.0 / 10.0

Award

Founder, Product Designer & Team Lead | Pitch2Win 2025 First Place Winner, Thryve Health Management AppOct 2025 – Nov 2025

- Took a 0→1 AI-assisted health-management concept through secondary research, competitive benchmarking, value proposition, feature prioritization, TAM/SAM/SOM, pricing, business model, GTM, technology options, wireframes, AI prototype, branding, pitch development, and financial modeling.
- Won 1st Place among 17 teams at Pitch2Win 2025.

AI enabled Product workflow

- Built reusable **Claude Skills** to support UX research workflows, synthesis, hypothesis generation, and critique.
- Use AI as a **devil's advocate** to uncover assumptions, edge cases, missing states, accessibility concerns, and broken product logic.
- Generate multiple user flows and product directions, provide AI with **personas and context**, and pressure-test how different users may experience each approach.
- Use **Claude Code, Cursor, Figma Make, Base44, Lovable, and v0** for functional prototypes through a **build → test → regenerate → refine** workflow.
- Use AI for **learning unfamiliar domains, UX writing, research synthesis, ideation, frontend exploration, accessibility review, and Engineering handoff**, while keeping final judgment grounded in users and product constraints.